

CLEAR PATH LEADERSHIP

Karsten Group's Working Genius

Leaders Session | June 25th, 2026

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DISCUSSION QUESTION

What's your favorite thing to do at work?

What's something others seem to enjoy doing at work, but you personally find draining?

Two Undeniable Truths

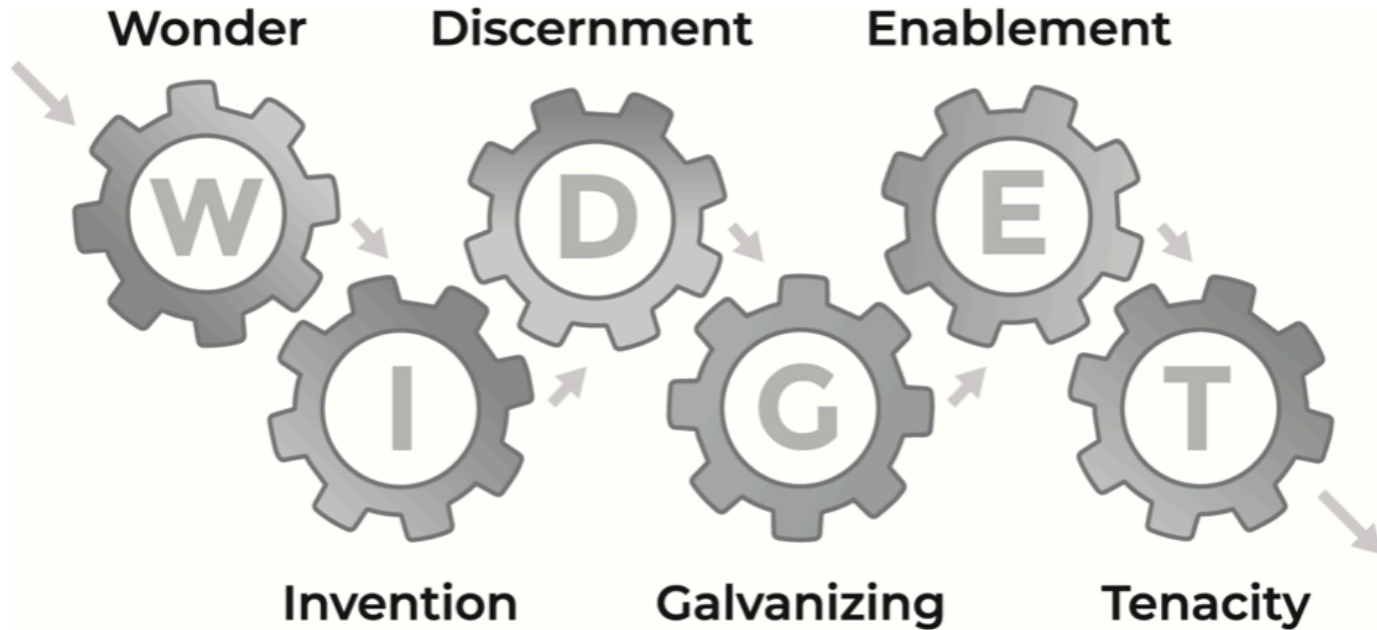
- People who utilize their natural talents are much more fulfilled and successful than those who don't.
- Teams and organizations that help people tap into their natural talents are more productive and successful than those who don't.

What is Working Genius?

- Working Genius is part productivity tool and part personality assessment.
 - It helps you understand what types of work you find most fulfilling (and most draining).
 - It helps us better understand how work gets done.
- Each person has two geniuses, two competencies, and two frustrations.

Defining Key Terms

- **Geniuses.** Areas of work you find most energizing and fulfilling. Often, these reflect natural giftedness.
- **Competencies.** Areas where you are capable and don't mind working sometimes.
- **Frustrations.** Areas when you don't derive energy and probably aren't naturally gifted.



Questions to Consider Throughout

- How (and when) do you get to use your Working Geniuses?
- When do you notice your Working Frustrations? How does this impact you and your team?
- How do you see others using their Working Geniuses?

The Genius of Wonder

- The genius of wonder involves pondering the possibility of greater potential or opportunity.
- People with the genius of wonder love to question assumptions, challenge the status quo, and consider why things are the way they are.
- Almost every new initiative, program, or project begins because someone wonders.

People With Wonder

- Things they may say:
 - “Why do we do it this way?”
 - “Can we do it better?”
 - “Maybe we should think about this more.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s never quite satisfied with how things are.”
 - “She’s always asking ‘why’ or ‘why not’.

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave consideration.** They want time and space to ask big questions and for others to validate and join them in their thinking.
- **They are crushed by being dismissed.** They don't like hearing phrases such as “who cares?” or “we don't have time to stop and think about that.”

The Genius of Invention

- The genius of invention involves creating original ideas and solutions - often with little or no direction.
- People with the genius of invention are typically confident and energized when faced with problems with no apparent solution.
- This genius is often the easiest one to recognize and appreciate.

People With Invention

- Things they may say:
 - “Hey, I’ve got an idea.”
 - “Here’s something that might work.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s so creative.”
 - “She’s always got a solution, even if we didn’t ask for one.”
 - “Where does he get all these ideas?”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave freedom.** They want to paint on a blank canvas and think outside the box.
- **They are crushed by constraints and premature judgment.** They want their ideas to be heard and valued, even if it's not quite time to move forward.

The Genius of Discernment

- The genius of discernment involves using instinct or intuition to assess and evaluate ideas.
- People with discernment enjoy considering whether ideas should be acted upon or if they need to be adjusted.
- Discernment helps people avoid going too far with ideas that aren't ready yet.

People With Discernment

- Things they may say:
 - “Now that is a great idea!”
 - “I don’t think this is going to work.”
 - “Here’s what might need to change.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s always got the best advice. Ask him.”
 - “I would trust her gut. She has strong intuition.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave trust.** They want people to validate their judgments, instincts, and assessments - even if there's still discussion about how to proceed.
- **They are crushed by skepticism.** They don't like being asked to "prove" what their gut or intuition is telling them.

The Genius of Galvanizing

- The genius of galvanizing involves rallying people around an idea and inspiring them to take action.
- People with the genius of galvanizing don't mind persuading others to think differently or change their plans.
- Galvanizing is necessary so that people will commit (and recommit) to moving forward.

People With Galvanizing

- Things they may say:
 - “Is everyone on board with this?”
 - “Come on! This is a huge opportunity.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “She has so much energy and passion for what we’re doing.”
 - “You can always count on him to get us going.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave reaction.** They want others to hear their galvanizing and affirm that what they are advocating for is real and worthwhile.
- **They are crushed by apathy.** They can feel disengaged or frustrated when nobody responds to their galvanizing or when they are ignored.

The Genius of Enablement

- The genius of enablement involves answering the call to action and providing support, encouragement, and assistance.
- Enablement is one of the hardest geniuses to define or understand - many people with this genius don't see it as a gift.
- However, people with enablement can be some of the best team players.

People With Enablement

- Things they may say:
 - “Let me know how I can help with this.”
 - “I want this to be successful. What do you need?”
- Things others say about them:
 - “Whenever I need help, he’s the first person I can count on.”
 - “She’s the best team player we have.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave genuine requests for help and appreciation for the role they played.** They don't have to be acknowledged on stage, but they want to hear that they are helping and making a difference.
- **They are crushed by being overlooked.** They don't want to be taken for granted or have their contributions go without being acknowledged.

The Genius of Tenacity

- The genius of tenacity involves pushing projects and tasks through to completion.
- People with tenacity love getting things done, crossing items off a list, and knowing that they met the standards for completion.
- You can count on somebody with the genius of tenacity to meet goals and complete projects even when challenges arise.

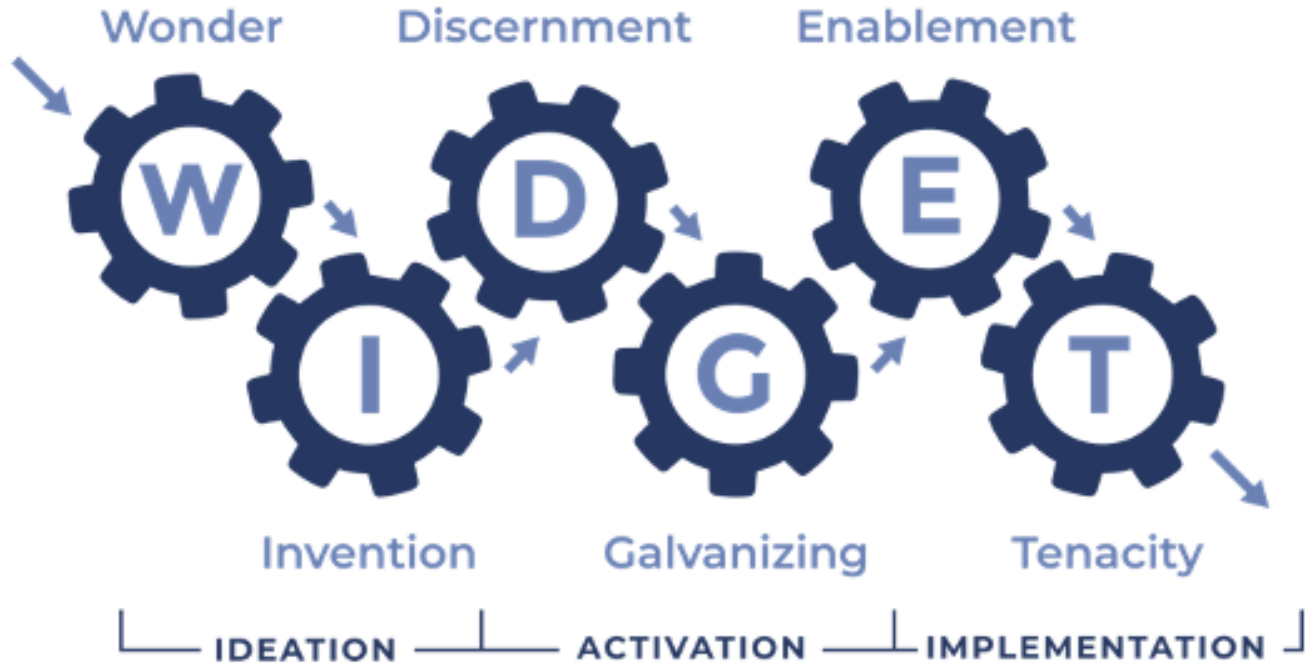
People With Tenacity

- Things they may say:
 - “Here, let me do it.”
 - “I’m worried we won’t meet our deadline.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “I don’t think she’s ever missed a deadline.”
 - “He’s going to do whatever it takes to get it done.”

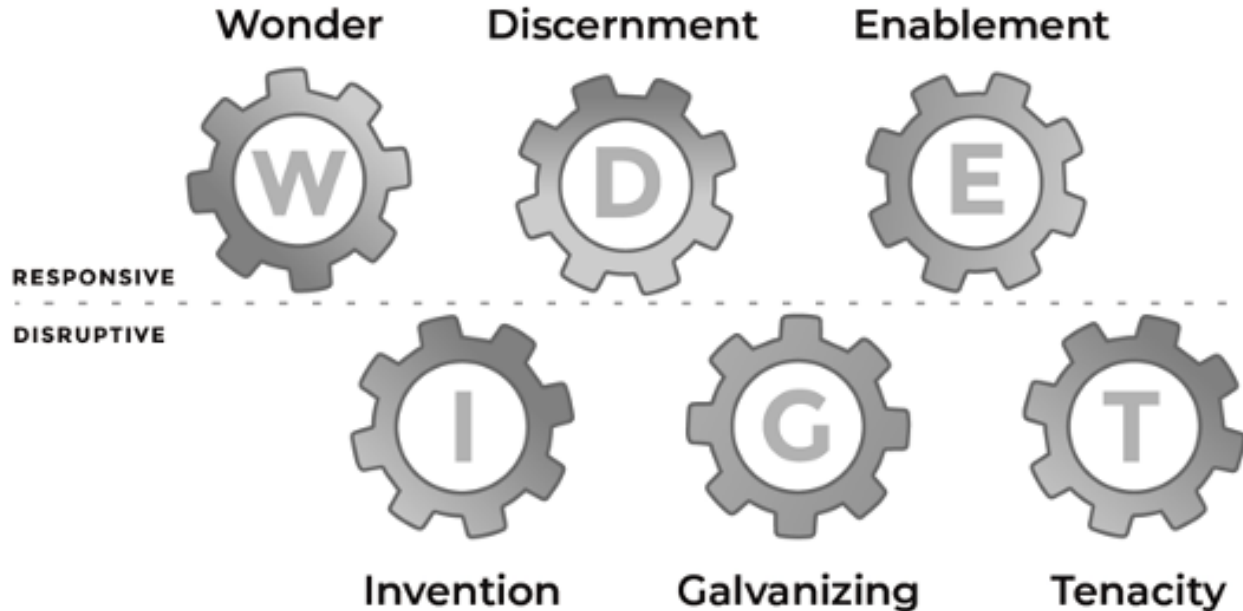
Craves and Crushes

- **They crave clarity.** They want to know exactly what steps are necessary for work to be considered “done.”
- **They are crushed by ambiguity or moving targets.** When they think they are working toward one goal and it changes unexpectedly, it can be frustrating.

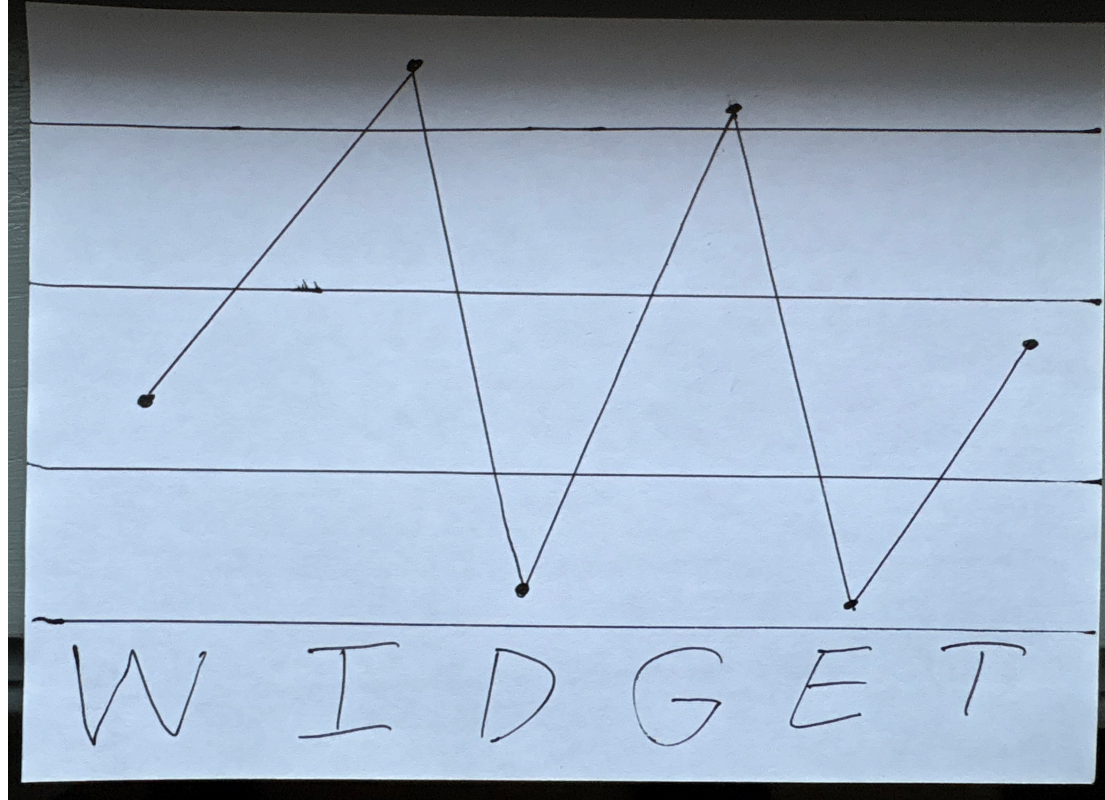
Three Stages of Work



Responsive and Disruptive Geniuses



Energy Mapping



Individual Profiles

RESULTS

Your Results

Braden, the information below summarizes the results of your assessment.

WORKING GENIUS:

Your areas of Working Genius are **Invention** and **Galvanizing**.



You are naturally gifted at and derive energy and joy from creating original and novel ideas and solutions.



You are naturally gifted at and derive energy and joy from rallying people and inspiring them to take action around ideas, projects, or tasks.

WORKING COMPETENCY:

Your areas of Working Competency are **Tenacity** and **Wonder**.



You are capable of and don't mind pushing projects and tasks through to completion to ensure that the desired results are achieved.



You are capable of and don't mind pondering the possibility of greater potential and opportunity in a given situation.

WORKING FRUSTRATION:

Your areas of Working Frustration are **Discernment** and **Enablement**.



You aren't naturally gifted at and don't derive energy and joy from using your intuition and instincts to evaluate and assess ideas or plans.



You aren't naturally gifted at and don't derive energy and joy from providing others with encouragement and assistance for projects and tasks.

PAIRING DESCRIPTION

Your Unique Pairing

IG | GI

The Evangelizing Innovator

While each of the genius types is important on its own, the combination or pairing of your two Working Geniuses can be just as insightful when it comes to identifying your unique talents and gifts. Below is a description of your pairing, which is the combination of **INVENTION** and **GALVANIZING**.

People with this pairing derive real joy and energy from generating new ideas and convincing others of an idea's merit. Exuberant and enthusiastic, they are not easily deterred by initial pushback, and enjoy the challenge of sharing ideas to convince others to act. They can be hasty to start selling ideas before taking time to fully consider the prudence of an idea, and can be initially perceived as slightly over-the-top in their approach.



THEY CRAVE:

-  **Freedom.** They want the freedom to create and invent without constraints or restrictions.
-  **Reaction.** They want engagement, and confirmation that the thing they are advocating for is real and worthwhile.

THEY ARE CRUSHED BY:

-  **Constraint.** They dislike restrictive parameters or being forced to stay 'inside the box.'
-  **Apathy.** They hate it when no one responds to their calls to action, or when their enthusiasm is met with silence.

Individual Applications

- Work in your areas of genius as often as possible.
- Be honest about your frustrations without guilt.
- Use people and systems to compensate for your frustrations.

Individual Applications

- Consider your geniuses and frustrations when planning your schedule.
- Acknowledge and appreciate the unique contributions of others.
- Use “lowercase” geniuses in areas of frustration for more productivity and engagement.

How will you apply Working Genius individually?

Break Activity

- During our break, fill out your blank Team Map with ONLY your direct reports.
- Reflect on a few questions:
 - What does this teach you about your team?
 - Where might you be using team members in the wrong way? How could you use them better?
 - Who might you have tension with simply because their geniuses are different than yours?

DISCUSSION QUESTION

What did the Team Map activity teach you about your team?

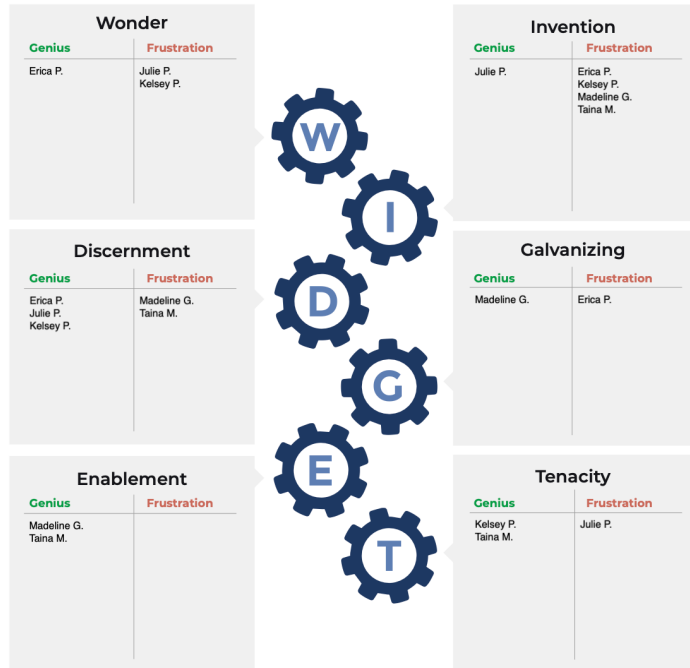
Where might you be using team members in the wrong way?

How could you use them better?

DISCUSSION QUESTION

Who might have tension because of their different perspectives?

Leaders Only Team Map



- What does this map teach us about our leadership team?
- Who might be playing out of position? How could they be better used?
- Who might have tension because of their different perspectives?

Team Applications

- Allow people to operate in their areas of genius as much as possible. (70/20/10 split)
- Don't be afraid to reconsider/reassign traditional responsibilities based on individual geniuses.
- Remember that each person brings value, regardless of what their geniuses are.

Team Applications

- Implement the language into conversations.
 - Example #1: “I haven’t discerned this idea yet.”
 - Example #2: “I’d love to bring you into this project for your enablement and tenacity.”

Team Applications

- Implement the language into conversations.
 - Example #1: “I haven’t discerned this idea yet.”
 - Example #2: “I’d love to bring you into this project for your enablement and tenacity.”
 - **How might you use this in 1:1’s with direct reports?**

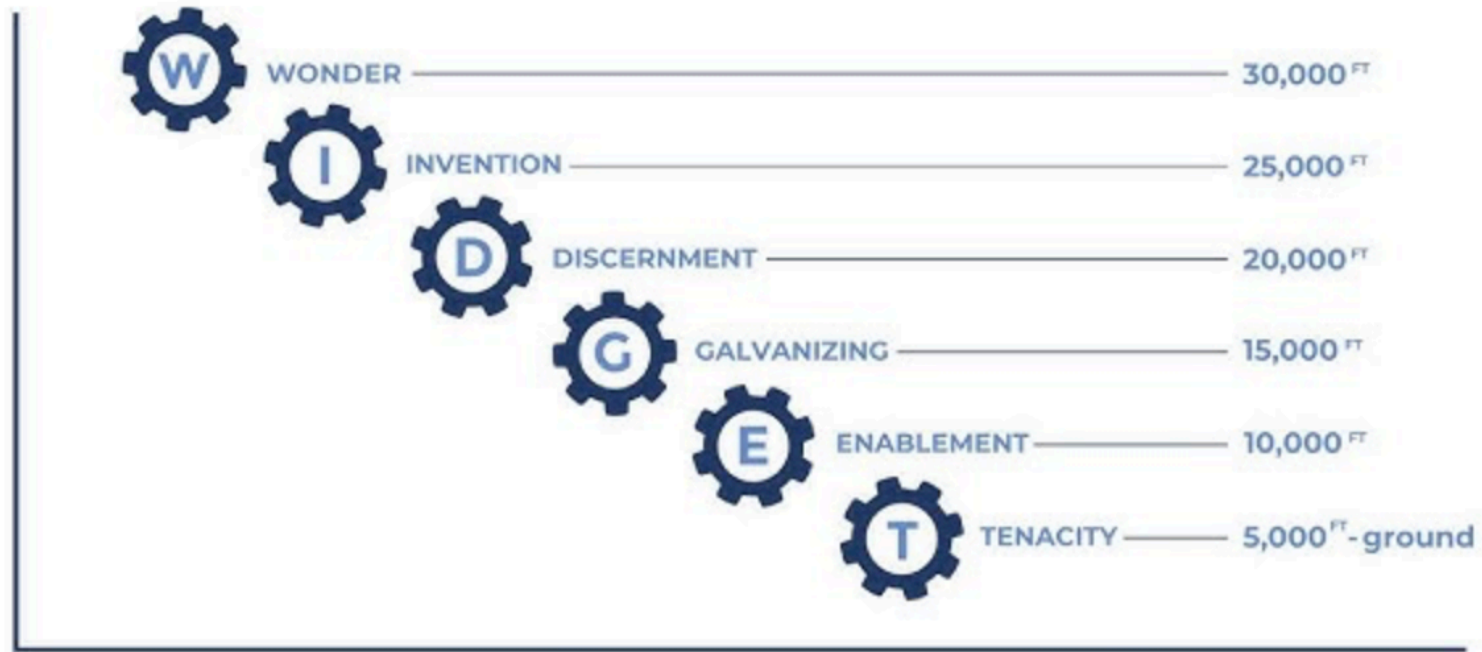
Team Applications

- Implement the language into conversations.
 - Example #1: “I haven’t discerned this idea yet.”
 - Example #2: “I’d love to bring you into this project for your enablement and tenacity.”
 - **What about conversations with clients?**

Team Applications

- Define what you need at specific points of work.
 - Example #1: “I don’t think we’ve wondered enough yet.”
 - Example #2: “We’ve moved past ideation. It’s time for activation.”
- **Remember that this is both personality assessment and productivity tool.**

The Altitude of Geniuses



Team Applications

- Don't over-rely on competencies.
- Use your team map to make meetings and projects better.
- Give everyone a chance to exercise their geniuses - even when it's not ABSOLUTELY necessary. It's an investment in that person's productivity and fulfillment at work.

Building a Genius-Oriented Culture

- At its core, culture is a set of shared beliefs. The more you advocate for Working Genius, the more others will buy in.
- This must start at the top with the leaders, and it will take time to fully experience results.
- Challenge is to think about today not as the ending, but as the beginning.

How can Working Genius strengthen our culture?

DISCUSSION QUESTION

What role can each person play?

DISCUSSION QUESTION

What will you do before our next meeting to prepare your team to learn about Working Genius?

Additional Resources from Table Group

- “The Six Types of Working Genius” book by Patrick Lencioni
- “The Six Times of Working Genius” podcast (usually releases new episodes on Wednesday)
- “The Six Types of Working Genius” website and resources

Additional Resources from Clear Path

- “Additional Working Genius Information”
handout
 - “When a Genius is Missing”
 - “Activating a Missing Genius”
 - “Collaborating with Each Genius”
- “Lowercase Genius Quick Guide”

Before Our Next Meeting

- Spend time reflecting on where you see your own geniuses and frustrations show up in your work.
- Try to reframe challenges and frustrations using the language you've learned today.
- Encourage team members when you see them using their geniuses (even if not by name).
- **Try to set one person on your team up for better success based on what you know about their geniuses (and yours).**